Security Audit Checklist Report

📚 Course

IT Security – Defense Against the Digital Dark Arts

👩‍💻 Student

Kgomotso Xaba

Submission Date

13 February 2026

- Project Overview

This project involved performing a basic security audit on a Windows computer.

The goal was to check important security settings and ensure the system is protected from cyber threats such as malware, unauthorized access, and vulnerabilities.

The audit focused on several key security areas including password strength, firewall protection, system updates, and malware scanning.

System Security Check

1. Password Strength
Status: Checked
Suggestion: Use a strong password with letters, numbers, and symbols.

2. Firewall Status
Status: ON
Suggestion: Make sure the firewall stays enabled for all networks.

3. Windows Updates
Status: Checked
Suggestion: Install updates regularly to fix security vulnerabilities.

4. Virus & Malware Scan
Status: Quick scan completed
Suggestion: Run regular scans to detect malware and threats.

5. Startup Programs
Status: Reviewed
Suggestion: Disable unnecessary startup programs to improve performance and security.

Improvements Made

- Firewall was confirmed to be **enabled**.
- The system was checked for **latest updates**.
- A **virus and malware scan** was performed.
- **Startup programs** were reviewed.

Suggestions for Better Security

- Use **strong passwords**.
- Keep the system **updated**.
- Run **virus scans regularly**.
- Avoid downloading files from **unknown sources**.